# Margaret Avery, MPA

**Nonprofit Professional**

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Kalamazoo, MI, 49007

## Overview

Nonprofit innovative leader with deep experience in program development, strategic planning, and securing transformational funding that propels organizational growth and mission impact. Proven expertise in managing diverse teams, cultivating collaborative partnerships, and expanding programs to meet the needs of underserved communities.

## Professional Experience

**Director of Community Advocacy Programs,** Michigan — Nov. 2021 – Current
*Equality Michigan*

- Expanded the Advocacy for Community Empowerment (ACE) department, increasing service reach in rural communities and developing innovative educational initiatives to address LGBTQ+ advocacy needs.
- Developed and maintained additional collaborative partnerships while developing & implementing new programs for legal, healthcare, and housing assistance.
- Directed and supported a diverse team of staff, volunteers, and interns, fostering a collaborative and inclusive work environment to deliver high-impact advocacy services.
- Secured funding and partnerships to develop & launch new programs, such as first/last month's rent assistance, family-friendly drag events, and LGBTQ+ youth book clubs, strengthening community engagement.
- Managed compliance with federal funding requirements, including the preparation and submission of detailed grant applications and reports under the Victim of Crime Act (VOCA).
- Delivered high quality survivor-centered, trauma-informed intensive case management to victims/survivors; developing service plans to match individual needs utilizing a range of financial, medical, social, legal, and other services and resources based on participants needs, eligibility, and priorities.

**Policy Analyst & Grant Writer,** Albion, MI — April 2023 – Current
*Albion Economic Development Corporation*

- Prepared compelling grant proposals, securing $20+ million in funding from local, regional, and national foundations, corporations, and government agencies.
- Analyzed regional economic conditions to identify pressing development needs, crafting data-driven proposals that aligned with local, state, and federal funding priorities.
- Provided strategic input on policy initiatives to support local economic growth, focusing on job creation, small business support, and infrastructure improvement.
- Conducted financial and economic impact analyses to inform policy recommendations and support strategic planning efforts for the AEDC.
- Designed initiatives like the Entrepreneur Coaching Program, targeting minority-owned business development and addressing systemic barriers to economic success.

**Fund Development Director,** Battle Creek, MI — Sept. 2022 – July 2025
*Battle Creek Area Habitat for Humanity*

- Revitalized Battle Creek Area Habitat for Humanity by securing critical funding when the organization faced closure, growing its financial stability and expanding operations to the highest level in a decade.
- Managed donor stewardship programs, ensuring regular communication and engagement with donors to maintain long-term relationships.
- Prepared compelling grant proposals, securing $3+ million in funding from local, regional, and national foundations, corporations, and government agencies.
- Led and managed fundraising initiatives, increasing revenue by over 200% to support capacity, programs, and services.
- Developed the strategic plan for 2024-2029 while implementing evaluation efforts, outreach updates, and funding plans.
- Closely collaborated with the Board of Directors to set fundraising goals and align them with organizational priorities.

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**Statewide Volunteer and Engagement Manager**, Michigan
*Reproductive Freedom for All* Aug. 2022 – Nov. 2022

- Supervised and advised over 500 volunteers across the state of Michigan to develop and implement all components of volunteer mobilization operation.
- Generated new activists and volunteers through organization, outreach, and special event efforts, resulting in an increase of volunteers.
- Headed campaign-wide goals and implemented them into daily/weekly benchmarks in 13 regions of Michigan.

## Education

**Grand Valley State University**, Grand Rapids, MI
*Graduate Degree- MPA*
Policy Analysis, Advocacy, Evaluation

**Grand Valley State University**, Allendale, MI
*Bachelor of Science*
Political Science, Legal Studies, and Women, Gender, and Sexuality Studies

## Skills

**Professionals Skills**: Advocacy & Outreach | Collaborative Problem-Solving | Stakeholder Engagement | Public Speaking | Strategic Planning | Budget Management | Leadership Development

**Technical Skills**: Policy Analysis | Grant Writing | Data Analysis | Project Management | Training Development | Resource Management | Evaluation Planning